



High Achiever

Want to Be the Best? Here's How Top Students Do It

Coming first in one exam is tough. Coming first in every assessment? That's the stuff of champions. You know who I'm talking about: the students who always seem to score 100%, as if success flows through their veins. But the truth is, it's not magic, and it's definitely not luck.

How badly do you want it? Success doesn't happen by chance; it's earned through hard work. Those top students? They're not superhuman. They simply maximise every tool, every resource, and every moment they have. So, what will you do with yours?

- Are you using the help provided to its full potential?
- Are you spending your time where it matters most?
- Are you completing every task, every practice, every revision like it counts?
- Are you taking your tutor's advice and turning it into action?
- Are you fully engaged, learning with focus and curiosity to succeed?
- Are you treating every lesson, every concept, and every opportunity to learn with the seriousness it deserves?

The reason they succeed often lies in these questions. The difference isn't talent. It's discipline, preparation, and consistency.

We've gathered insights from top-performing students across schools and grades in both Maths and English. Students who don't just come first in exams, but dominate them, achieving perfect scores time and time again. They're not just chasing excellence; they're defining it. These quiet achievers and relentless workers prove that perfection isn't a gift, rather it's a craft. It's built on habits, strategies, and unwavering dedication. Their success might look effortless, but it's powered by systems that leave nothing to chance.

Now comes the best part: they've shared the exact strategies that helped them rise—practical steps you can start applying today. Because success isn't a distant dream. It's a choice you make every single day—to learn, to grow, to adapt, and to push beyond where you are right now. It's in the small habits, the focused effort, and the refusal to let setbacks define you that champions are made.

Are you ready to stop watching others win and start claiming your own success? This isn't just their moment. It's yours. Step up, show up, and let's make it happen.



Anna Nguyen

Appreciation

I used to be so bad at maths that I would tell everyone it was my worst subject, and I *hated* it. Then I was placed in Ms Amanda's class. She didn't just teach maths. She changed the way I thought about it. She made me stop saying it was my worst subject and helped me see that I *could* improve. Her teaching style was unique, inspiring, and so easy to understand that the lessons just *stuck*.

Trust me, having the right tutor changes everything. My cousin introduced me to DA, swearing by how a great tutor who cares and knows their stuff can change your marks. And she was right. Ms Amanda was strict, and after my first lesson, I honestly thought, "This is too hard for me." But thank goodness I listened to my parents and stuck with it. Ms Amanda turned me from a student aiming *not to fail* to someone who refuses to settle for anything less than first place or 100%.

Here's what I learned the hard way: you can't pick and choose what advice to follow. At first, I only listened to what I *thought* was right, and while I improved, I wasn't topping the grade.

Then I started paying attention to the top kids in my class at DA. What were they doing differently? They *listened*. They followed every piece of advice their tutors gave them and did things that made a real difference: They did all their homework. They practised every exam question given by her. They prioritised the important things. They stayed focused, enjoyed every lesson and loved coming to class.

So I made changes. I also took on her advice of cutting out distractions—no more gaming or scrolling on my phone until I'd finished my work. I started treating games as a reward, not a habit. My phone? I only used it when necessary. These small changes freed up so much of my time and gave me the space to focus on what mattered most.

Advice for Current Students

If there's one piece of advice I can give you, it's this: take responsibility for your marks and your actions. Blaming others, making excuses, or pointing to circumstances will only keep you stuck in the same habits and with the same results.

That used to be me before I joined DA. I always had an excuse for my parents about why I failed a test. But after a deep, honest talk with Ms Amanda, I learned to stop making excuses and start taking accountability. I reflected on where things went wrong: I was cramming for exams at the last minute, I wasn't practising enough exam questions, and I wasn't putting in consistent effort.

Admitting my mistakes was hard, but it allowed me to learn from them and avoid repeating them. Slowly, my marks began to improve, and my confidence grew.

Another key lesson? Don't always follow your feelings. Do what's needed and what's right. It's easy to stick with a tutor because they're friendly and make you feel comfortable, but comfort doesn't always equal progress. My old tutor was nice and friendly, but I wasn't improving. I stayed in my comfort zone, convinced that I was just bad at the subject.

Sometimes, pressure is necessary to succeed. Discipline is required to grow out of bad habits. A tough, fair, caring, and smart teacher makes all the difference. They push you to do better, hold you accountable, and help you become the best version of yourself.





Ryan Tran

Appreciation

If you think every student who tops their grade was born brilliant, think again. Some people are blessed with natural talent but that wasn't the case for me.

When I entered high school, I was failing or barely passing every English assessment. The subject felt like an insurmountable wall. Unlike maths, where my parents could step in to help, I felt completely on my own. But everything changed when I joined DA and heard something that shifted my perspective: It's not my parents' job to do my assignments. My poor marks weren't due to a lack of help, they came from gaps in my skills and foundation.

A turning point came one evening at tutoring when I sat next to a girl in maths who shared her story. She had once struggled with English as I did, yet now she was consistently topping the grade after joining Ms Lai's class. That conversation sparked hope in me, if she could do it, why couldn't I? Belief is powerful, but belief combined with the right effort and support changes everything.

With Ms Lai's guidance, I learned that a great tutor does more than teach content; they instil discipline, correct your weaknesses, and push you to exceed your own expectations. She taught me to commit to the process, I worked harder, and did what was necessary rather than what was comfortable and easy. I took on double English to make up for lost time, and now, while I don't love the subject, I do enjoy it and I consistently score A range marks. Definitely a far cry from my 'barely passing' days.

It turns out success isn't reserved for the "naturally gifted". It's for those willing to embrace the right mindset, seek the right guidance, and put in the work.

Advice for Current Students

My advice to any student at DA is simple: never accept the idea that you're just "not good" at something. Skills aren't set in stone. They can be developed. I know this firsthand. I started in the bottom English class, and now I'm not only in the top class but consistently achieving top 3. It didn't happen overnight, and it certainly wasn't easy. But if you keep trying, you will see progress. Even if you don't reach the very top, you'll climb higher than you thought possible. Giving up, on the other hand, guarantees that nothing will change.

One of the most important lessons I've learned is to seek the right help and actually use it. Don't hesitate to ask your parents or teachers for guidance because believe it or not, they actually want to see you succeed. For me, changing tutors was a turning point. Receiving the right support was life-changing: my marks improved, my confidence soared, and I genuinely began to enjoy English (something I never thought possible). That success has inspired me to take the same approach with maths next term. I'm ready to put in the work, seek help, and build my skills. If English has taught me anything, it's this: the right mindset, combined with the right support, can turn any weakness into a strength. Don't be afraid to start, don't be afraid to struggle. Just don't stop.





Lucas Nguyen

Appreciation

I have found that a deep connection with the material taught by the teachers at DA have led to my academic success. Notably, the guidance and expertise of tutors have been pivotal in developing my academic ability. A prime example is my work in mathematics under the mentorship of both Ms. Amanda and Ms. Linda, I have been able to cultivate deep insights into complex mathematical concepts through their “gangsta method”. Her tailored approach, which emphasizes problem-solving techniques and the application of abstract principles, has enabled me to approach challenges with clarity and confidence.

Similarly, Miss Lai’s instruction in English has been instrumental in enhancing my analytical and literary skills. Her emphasis on critical analysis of complex techniques, structured writing, and nuanced interpretation has not only sharpened my comprehension but also refined my ability to articulate ideas coherently and persuasively. Both tutors’ attention to detail has made this a place where I can excel academically and actually develop a love for learning.

Advice for Current Students

I encourage fellow peers to take up the recommendations of our tutorial. Their guidance has personally allowed me to develop discipline in school and my studies; furthermore the enemy of success is procrastination, so one should ensure to devote time to each subject, not to memorize superficially but to understand deeply. On a similar note, I wish you would look for extra “help class” support to consolidate what I acquire in class.

My academic experience with Miss. Amanda and Miss Lai underscores the potential that personalized direct instruction may have on one’s academic excellence. Their tailored feedback and attentive guidance have been essential in both mitigating my weaknesses and whittling down my strengths for better service. It is also important to accept the process of making mistakes because it is often the most instructive moments. Mistakes are inevitable in the learning process and are imperative in one’s growth academically.

Finally, the development of genuine curiosity and love for the subject turns academic work from a duty into an intellectually enriching process. When learning becomes a pursuit of knowledge rather than a task to be completed, the path to excellence becomes significantly more attainable. And hence, I hope my academic excellence can serve as motivation for those reading these lines.

Edmond Giang

Appreciation

A few main factors that have allowed me to be able to consistently reach first place in the grade on multiple exams are determination to succeed and make my mentors proud is a driving force.

They have spent precious time and resources for me to succeed, my dedication to maintain a consistent study routine allowed me to be able to effectively work while minimising stress. Forming an effective study plan allowed me to become organised and confident with the material I’m studying. DA has been a huge factor for my learning as well, providing work that always challenged my creativity and ascended me to new heights.

The teachers at DA have been exceptional, delivering engaging lessons that are both memorable and impactful. Their ability to present information in an enjoyable yet informative manner ensures that key concepts resonate deeply within me, allowing me to gain an invaluable advantage, helping me perform at my best.

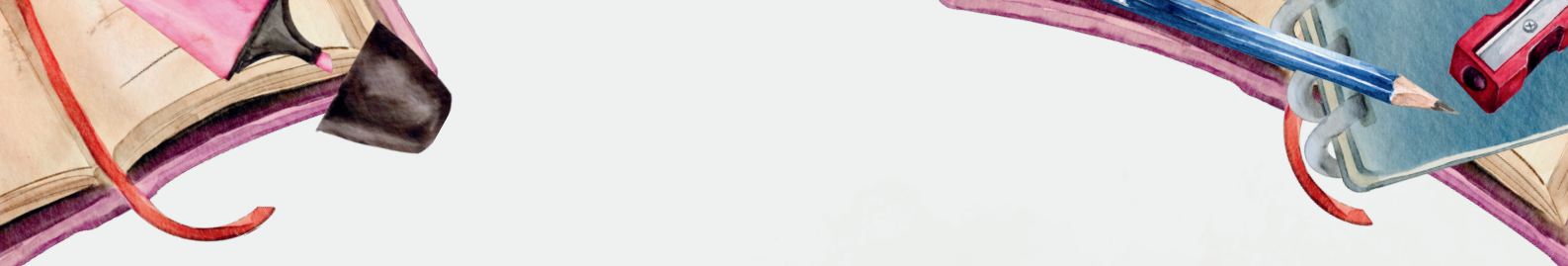
Advice for Current Students

My advice towards other kids is to start by understanding your strengths and weak points. Focus on improving your weak points and never be afraid to ask for help from mentors or friends. Creating a study group can make learning more engaging and enjoyable, as you can share ideas, discuss topics, and motivate one another.

Another advice that is essential, is that you should begin studying earlier than the last minute. This allows you to be able to understand all the material needed without stressing too much, many people don’t get their desired marks because of studying last minute.

From experience, cramming at the last minute is rarely effective and often leads to unnecessary stress.





Joie Lim

Appreciation

A lot of practice. To gain confidence, I would practice the various kinds of questions they might ask on tests. As a result, I could respond to it faster during the test and would know instantly what approach would work best. It has strengthened my comprehension of the subject and given me more self-assurance when taking tests.

Constantly getting feedback. To get feedback, I would routinely turn in or show my work to my teachers and tutors. The critique can take the form of correcting a mistake or offering pointers and advice that helped me identify an appropriate approach to problem-solving. I would ask friends and family members in addition to my teachers.

Past exams. I usually just go over my past exams again and review the problems that were very difficult and the ones that I answered wrong. In order to structure my answers for real exams and receive the most points possible, I would additionally go through past tests and examine sample solutions.

Advice for Current Students

Make use of as many of the materials that DA has to offer. For every topic, DA offers a wide range of resources. Past exams, flash cards, booklets (for certain subjects), sample essays, and much more are included. Additionally, don't be scared to ask questions of your teachers at school and at DA. I would occasionally be nervous to question my teachers for fear of being judged. However, I then saw that I was losing out on important details that might have strengthened my understanding of a particular subject and improved my studies.

Olira Liong

Appreciation

The main factors I believe have greatly contributed to helping me receive first in the grade in school exams are practice and speed. I do as many questions as I can of the material that would help me become better at ones I'm not so confident in and then mark the questions and see where I went wrong to Improve on before the exam. When it comes to the exam, I read all questions properly and underline the key things I need to answer. I do these efficiently regarding the mark allocation and usually finish with 30-40 minutes left depending on the subject. With this time, I consistently check over my work and redo the questions which equates to roughly 3-5 times, where accuracy plays a role.

Advice for Current Students

Advice and tips I'd like to share with others on how to achieve the same goal would be listen attentively in class, do all the work that is assigned and that the more work you put in the more that is rewarded to you. I used to not be the most enthusiastic when it came to school, especially the exams. However, this was overcome with discipline and hard work which motivated me to do more, with the eagerness to receive more rewards and achieve more goals.





Selina Ho

Appreciation

Besides studying for exams, it is truly the motivation that drives me to getting places. There are times where I don't feel my best and confident for exams, and this is where you go to others to find help and motivation. I really do thank all the tutors from DA that push me to do my best. I never was the kid that would be first in the grade, instead I would be in the low seventies. Even after a bad result for an exam, having motivation and a good support network of people around you will take you places. Likewise, your tutors are really good people that can help you find that motivation and drive to do better. If anything, have the mindset of someone that is first in the grade. No one that's first in the grade hates the subject, never studies, and has a negative mindset. Live your dreams and goals, and eventually they will happen with the motivation from others and willpower of yours!

Advice for Current Students

Being first isn't easy, the hardwork is never the actual studying itself either. My biggest piece of advice I wish I knew is to find comfort in making mistakes and learning from them. I used to view mistakes as the end-all-be-all. It really isn't it takes a change of mindset to see it different. Tutor is a great place to make mistakes, you will find that it is much better to make them at DA as well. When studying for an exam, I like to write all my mistakes onto a separate paper and stick it somewhere on my room. I can't lie, it hurts to see them, but it's the pain that makes it unforgettable. Despite the pain, find comfort in making them because the more you make, the more you can perfect yourself. Besides the mental challenge of mistakes, physically writing them down and seeing them will prevent you from making mistakes again ever.

Outtara Nhem

Appreciation

Firstly, I think the main factors that helped me was my passion for maths. There is nothing that can overcome this factor. If you don't enjoy the subjects you are taking, then you are limiting yourself. I think by liking the subject, instead of thinking of homeworks as something you need to do just for the sake of it, it becomes something you would like to do. This thrill really comes from topics you find particularly difficult but through the hard work you put in, you will start to see improvements and think to yourself "omg! I never thought I'd be able to do this" and I would say this mindset of always trying to see improvements in areas I'm weak in helped me. Moreover, another factor that helped me is definitely tutoring. My tutor explained each topic very clearly which helped me understand and apply the concepts taught easily. This combined with the constant push for success really helped me attain all those high marks.

Advice for Current Students

I would say you need to try to understand all the topics at the time they are taught. You shouldn't have the mentality of skipping topics that you find difficult and saying that you'll come back to it later because you won't have time. If you find it extremely difficult, I would recommend going tutoring as all topics in year 11 and 12 are tested in the HSC, so it is essential you understand each topic fully. Moreover, since most topics are linked up, if you don't understand one, it might affect your understanding of another topic and so on and thus, would really be detrimental to your whole understanding of the subject.





Sasha Fugencio

Appreciation

I believe what helped me consistently achieve top marks in all of my school exams stemmed from the genuine interest and appreciation I had for each of my subjects which ultimately fueled my willingness to engage with content and succeed. By developing study habits and understanding how to balance each subject depending on how confident I was with my abilities in them was also crucial in determining academic success. Of course, my tutors played a pivotal role in helping achieve first place in exams, not only encouraging me to push beyond my perceived limits but also illuminating concepts in different lights allowing me to better understand the content. Through their unrelenting support and unique insights I was able to consistently stay at the top during my exams.

Advice for Current Students

The key advice I'd share with others aiming to achieve the highest rank in every exam is to understand that reaching the top is challenging, but maintaining that position requires even greater effort. Realising this is what pushed me the most to try harder each assessment and stay disciplined throughout my HSC year. Also, engaging in class, both at school and during tutoring sessions, is essential as I believe that was another factor that led to my academic success. By asking questions and seeking clarity I was able to deepen my understanding of my courses and solidify knowledge. Consistent effort, a proactive mindset, and a genuine desire to be the best is what cultivates success.



Jimmy Sien

Appreciation

The main factors on contributing to my academic results is the consistency and amount of preparation for each exam. These main factors include Miss Amanda's amount of past papers, booklets with selective questions and the high standard she sets on the amount she expects by every week. The amount of practice with my fundamentals and then harder math questions had aided me on my academic results when coming to extension and advanced maths. Furthermore, in English, the care and quality of editing suggestions when it comes to receiving feedback has aided me on making my responses more specific and critical to addressing my assessment task questions.

Advice for Current Students

Some advice I would give when preparing for assessment tasks is for maths, to consistently put effort and attempt to memorise formulas across all topics to not fall behind, as the amount of topics can become overwhelming. As for English, starting assessments/essays earlier save a lot of stress and allow for more time to receive feedback with higher quality. An overall tip is to not take your holidays for granted, and try to attempt some math techniques, start an essay or read into your future topics for the upcoming term. I am very grateful for DA and how far they have allowed me to progress on my academic courses.





Paul Vu

Appreciation

The reason for my fantastic track record comes down to two reasons, choosing a subject I care about and having a drive to force me to work consistently. Focusing on areas I am genuinely interested in made studying much more enjoyable and less taxing. Even though I am a very math-centred person who thinks in a more logical manner, I still chose to pursue music and still managed to come first, something that never could have happened if I did not enjoy this subject. Of course, passion was not enough to prop me ahead of everyone else, so the effort had to be placed, which came from the many sources of motivation around me. I had both teachers and tutors pushing me to do the best I could and not waste my ability as well as the need to succeed for my family's financial situation. It was a combination of both these factors that drove me into first for so many of my exams.



Sophia Pham

Appreciation

I definitely think that by developing an early mindset that I could be first, that I was capable of doing well no matter what enabled me to be able to do well in school. With help from DA, and my tutor Miss Linda, who encouraged me throughout the process, pushing me to work harder, I was able to maintain confidence in myself that reflected in my school exams. I was able to consistently do well with much practice, because that is the only way perfection is reached. Putting myself in a positive environment and mindset allowed me to focus on reaching my goals and strive to be the best. I would say that being granted the opportunity to complete generous homework and communicate with my peers in my DA classroom enabled me to learn better, grasp concepts faster and therefore perform better in school. I would always go into an exam room being confident that I understood the material being assessed, and this is the major factor that I believe set me apart from the rest of my grade.

Advice for Current Students

I cannot stress enough the significance of collaboration in helping both you and others in succeeding. In cases where both students are of equal ability, the two perspectives allow for the identification and rectification of gaps in understanding. In mixed-ability groups, however, what may appear on the surface as one person pestering another actually benefits both parties. For the learner, seeking clarification helps them understand concepts more deeply. For the educator, the process of teaching requires them to solidify their understanding to explain effectively. Additionally, the questions given by the learner are often more difficult in nature, providing a challenge the educator and thus enhancing their skills further.

Advice for Current Students

For others who are hoping to achieve the same results as I have had, I would say that consistency is the most important concept that a student should learn before studying. It isn't being consistent for a day, or for a couple of weeks or months, it's about showing dedication year after year. Getting a question or two wrong in practice is important, so you can learn from your mistakes and persevere, especially in your exam, rather than giving up. I certainly believe that mistakes are meant to be made, because that is how we grow, so you shouldn't be discouraged when you don't understand a topic or make a silly mistake. This only pushes us to do better, to check out work, and to focus on our consistency and accuracy, particularly under pressure. I truly believe that anyone is capable of achieving great results in school, because it really only roots back to your drive and passion for greatness.





Adrian Nguyen

Appreciation

DA tuition has majorly contributed to my consistency in scoring 1st place in so many tests. Throughout this year, I have scored 100% on 3 exams and averaged 99% in maths. What majorly benefited me was using the study room before every exam. This was helpful, providing me with a quiet environment to study and ask questions. Another factor that helped me score high marks was asking for extra study material during exam periods. Before every exam, I always try to expose myself to as many variations of questions that could be on the exam by asking my teacher for additional study material. I found that this was really helpful, majorly benefitting my performance on the test.

Advice for Current Students

Staying consistent is the biggest piece of advice that I could give. Staying consistent means always completing homework when possible and attempting all work with effort. As a kid, I always scored mediocre marks, starting out as a C student. In DA, I constantly scored in the 60's for homework. This did not change overnight. After consistently completing my homework for the next 3 years, I finally broke past 90% marks and began to score high it's to 90's for homework. I believe that my consistency in completing homework has contributed to my ability to score well in all of my school exams, achieving 1st place in maths.



Dylan Nguyen

Appreciation

DA has supported me throughout my high school journey and has demonstrated their utmost commitment to my studies by matching my personal standards with my academic success in English and Mathematics. The main factor that assisted my ranks in English was the passionate tutors who go beyond their efforts to input their insights into my analytical essay writings. For Maths, I was able to consistently come first in the grade because of the amount of practice material and guidance that DA has provided me. Without homework and practice questions, I would not have found sufficient material to hone my mathematical skills to my greatest.

Advice for Current Students

I cannot stress enough the significance of collaboration in helping both you and others in succeeding. In cases where both students are of equal ability, the two perspectives allow for the identification and rectification of gaps in understanding. In mixed-ability groups, however, what may appear on the surface as one person pestering another actually benefits both parties. For the learner, seeking clarification helps them understand concepts more deeply. For the educator, the process of teaching requires them to solidify their understanding to explain effectively. Additionally, the questions given by the learner are often more difficult in nature, providing a challenge the educator and thus enhancing their skills further.





Raymond Trinh

Appreciation

The first factor which helped me to do well is my own desire and resolve. Often I would be tempted to procrastinate but I was always reminded of how important it is to me to maintain my grades. It is understandable that this discipline is not easy for everyone to attain. However this personal restraint allowed me to do my best.

The second factor, possibly the most important for me, is the support I received from others whether it be family, friends or tutors. I feel extremely grateful for my mum who always encourages me to do my best. Additionally, all the kind tutors have done so much for me, such as taking time outside of class to clarify any concerns that I may have and also teaching more than just the subject like life skills to set me up for success.

Finally the last factor is my ability to move on from failures. This final factor is an important lesson which Miss Amanda left lingering in my mind. I'm not talking about treating your mistakes indifferently and forgetting about them. While it is important to recover from a failure with a positive mindset, you should still recall mistakes and learn from them. These mistakes whether small and silly or not, I would often be harsh on myself making sure to not repeat them.

Advice for Current Students

Tips I would share to other kids who want to achieve the same goal as me is to put in the time and effort to improve as even To achieve the same goal, I suggest you take advantage of all your resources. As a student of DA it is incredibly easy to get the right resources to supplement your weaknesses. It's just a matter of taking some free time to complete extra work to boost your confidence when it comes to exam-style questions. Moreover, a main obstacle for many students is the way they perceive themselves. Many students are daunted by the fact they are not as talented or as capable as others, and as a result they give up. Not as in giving up studying but rather giving up on surpassing or matching their peers. Personally I believe the hard work and effort you put in outweighs talent. So my final piece of advice is to stay hard working and to keep reminding yourself of your goal. 30 minutes a day can improve drastically and to manage any work needed to make studying more smooth and effective.



Chloe Lam

Appreciation

My top three reasons that contribute to topping my grade are consistent effort, hardwork and the support I received from my tutor, Miss Jenny. She provided me with guidance, helping me understand difficult concepts and offering personalised strategies to improve my performance. Additionally, entering a disciplined approach towards my study, along with staying persistent even during challenging moments has helped me build a strong foundation and continuously improve.

Advice for Current Students

Tips I would share to other kids who want to achieve the same goal as me is to maintain a motivated and hardworking mindset as well as staying consistent.

Make sure to review your work regularly and ask for help when needed, whether from teachers or tutors. Most importantly, stay positive and don't be afraid to make mistakes. Learning from your setbacks is a vital part of improving and succeeding. Put in the time and effort to improve as even 30 minutes a day can improve drastically and to manage any work needed to make studying more smooth and effective.





Leon Heng

Appreciation

The main factors which have contributed to helping me come first in the grade for so many school exams is mainly due to time management. Time management has allowed me to avoid stress completing assessments early giving more time to study and improve when the next assessment arrives. Another factor is consistently doing homework with full working out with solutions. This allows me to recite all my formulas and techniques to avoid any mistakes in the future.

Advice for Current Students

Tips I would share to other kids who want to achieve the same goal as me is to put in the time and effort to improve as even 30 minutes a day can improve drastically and to manage any work needed to make studying more smooth and effective.



Marcus Nguyen

Appreciation

The main factor that contributed to my success in school was learning to be competitive and study more than everyone else. The DA tutors really helped me out with this by providing all the resources I needed and keeping me accountable for my work and my marks.

Advice for Current Students

The main advice I would have to give to another student wanting to improve but not having the drive or motivation to do so is to learn to love the subject you do at school. I used to hate doing maths and found it tedious to do, but DA has broadened my mindset and made me appreciate and enjoy the work I was studying. This made it so much easier to improve and understand the work which I believe ultimately contributed to my success in school.

